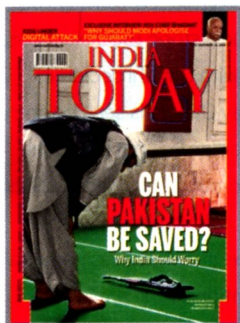


Can Pakistan Be Saved?

NOVEMBER 16, 2009

With a wave of terror attacks, its army battling jihadis, the political system deeply divided and its economy in tatters, Pakistan is close to collapse. Can it be saved?



“The danger of Pakistan falling into the hands of the Taliban is now real. It must survive as a civilised state for which waging a fight-to-the-finish war against all terrorist groups in Pakistan is necessary.”

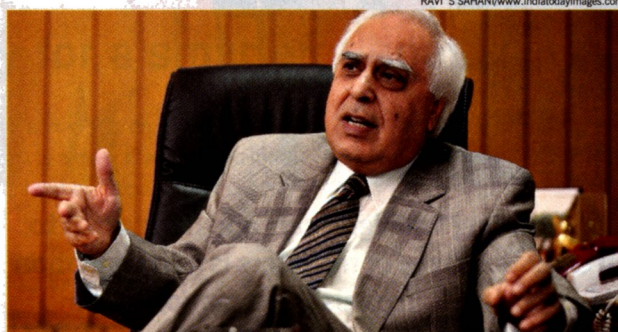
M.C. JOSHI, *Lucknow*

War Next Door

It's in our interest that Pakistan wins its war against the Taliban and other terrorist groups ("Can Pakistan be Saved?", November 16). Meanwhile, we should lend moral support to our neighbour and must not do anything that could be misunderstood. This is not the time to fish in troubled waters. The US is lending active support to the Pakistan Army but ultimately Pakistan will have to win this war on its own. The Taliban is a force to reckon with in certain tribal areas. Pakistan would do well in taking the help of tribal leaders who have nothing to do with the Taliban.

DBN MURTHY, *Bangalore*

Pakistan is definitely close to collapse, and the



Loud and Clear

One would think that "the vision for education and the will to reform it" are more significant qualities than announcing a policy before implementing it ("Mr Loud Speaker", November 16). What is wrong with announcing a policy beforehand? Many well-intentioned policies have come to grief because they weren't widely debated. The stupendous tasks at hand—universal elementary education, access to quality education, vocational and higher education—need to be taken up on a war footing. So the minister in charge of education should be a man in a hurry. As a member of his Round Table for School Reform, I have attended meetings chaired by Sibal and have not seen him exhibit any ideological leanings or penchant for privatisation. India needs people like him who have the will to do what needs to be done.

DEVI KAR, *Principal, Modern High School for Girls, Kolkata*

quicker the better. Why try to save it at all? Let it go to hell. The country has dug its own grave; let it lie in it now. In fact, the Taliban have done India a huge favour. What we could not do in 62 years, it has done in a couple of months.

ADI F. MERCHANT, *Mumbai*

Things Fall Apart

Though RSS chief Mohanrao Bhagwat exhibits his sharp mind on many challenging problems that the country faces, he shows no contemporary thinking on the crucial issues of Hindu ideology and attitude towards Pakistan ("The new BJP leader will be from outside Delhi", November 16). While his insistence on a young leadership taking over the BJP is right, young leaders propagat-

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